

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 4 3
♥ A 8 5 4
♦ J 7 4 2
♣ 9 4

♠ A Q 6

♥ K 7 3

♦ K 6

♣ K 10 6 5 3



♠ J 10 8 2

♥ J 10 2

♦ Q 10 5

♣ J 8 2

♠ K 7 5

♥ Q 9 6

♦ A 9 8 3

♣ A Q 7

Yes, this has nothing to do with Gerber or Blackwood, but everything to do with smart bidding.

NORTH has a 16 points and SOUTH has 15, 16 or 17. NORTH wants to be in 6NT if SOUTH has 17, but merely a Notrump game if she has 15 or 16.

The way to find out is to bid 4NT - not Blackwood but merely an invitation to bid 6NT. In this case, SOUTH has but 15 points and declines the invitation. If her ♥Q were changed to the ♥A she would bid 6NT and collect her twelve easy tricks.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
			1NT
Pass	4NT		
All Pass			
4NT by South			

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 5 3
♥ A 4 3 2
♦ Q 10 9 2
♣ 9 3

♠ K Q J 4
♥ K 6
♦ K 4
♣ K Q J 10 5



♠ A 8 7 6
♥ Q J 7
♦ A J 3
♣ A 8 2

♠ 9 2
♥ 10 9 8 5
♦ 8 7 6 5
♣ 7 6 4

When SOUTH opens 1NT NORTH hopes his hand includes all four Aces so she can bid 7NT. So she uses Gerber to find out.

But, when she discovers they are missing an Ace she settles for 6NT.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
			1NT
Pass	4♣	Pass	4NT
Pass	6NT		
All Pass			
6NT by South			